

The Water Cycle

Use the cue, then fade the cue. Study the cue card for 60 seconds. Then cover it before answering Round 1. Check the card only after you commit to an answer.

CUE FOCUS The Sun powers the water cycle. **Evaporation** turns liquid water into water vapor. **Condensation** turns vapor back into tiny drops that form clouds. **Precipitation** is rain or snow that falls. **Collection** and runoff return water to lakes, rivers, and oceans. Then it repeats.

Round 1 — Retrieve It

1. What gives the water cycle its energy?

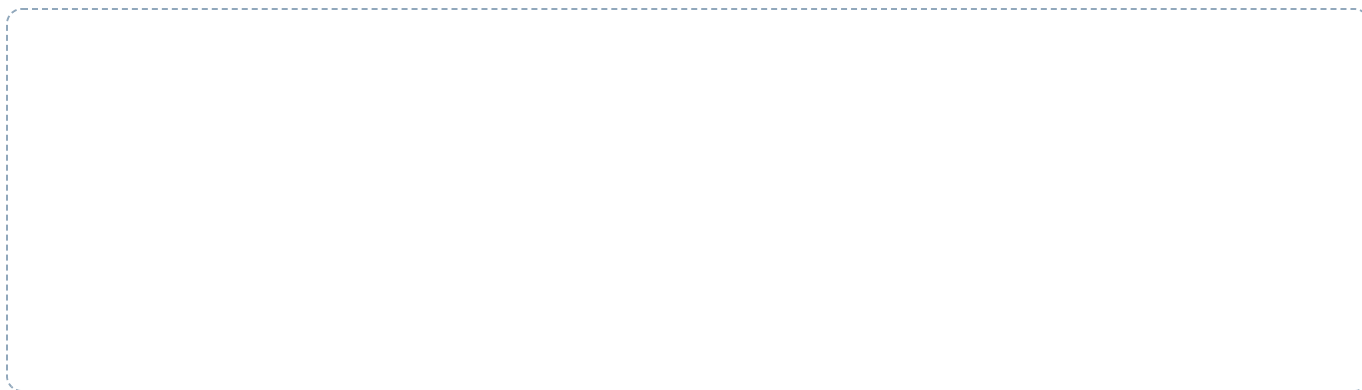
2. What is it called when liquid water turns into water vapor?

3. What forms when water vapor cools and condenses in the sky?

4. Name one kind of precipitation.

Round 2 — Sketch It

Draw the water cycle. Show the Sun, water evaporating from a lake, a cloud forming, and rain falling back down. Label evaporation, condensation, and precipitation.



The Water Cycle — Apply It

Keep the cue card covered. Answer first. Then use the cue to check, revise, and explain what you changed.

Round 3 — Apply the Idea

1. On a hot day, a puddle slowly disappears. Which part of the water cycle is happening, and where did the water go?

2. Water drops form on the outside of a cold glass of lemonade. Which part of the water cycle does this show, and why?

3. After a rainstorm, water flows down a hill into a river. What is this part of the cycle called, and where might the water go next?

Round 4 — Reason from Evidence

A student says, "New water is being made when it rains." Is that correct? Use what you know about the water cycle to explain your answer.

The Water Cycle — ACE It

Use the cue card only if you need it. The goal is to show what you can explain, connect, and use on your own.

A**Articulate**

Explain the water cycle in your own words. Use the words evaporation, condensation, and precipitation in order.

C**Connect**

Connect the water cycle to the weather you see. How does condensation help clouds form before it rains?

E**Extend**

The Sun powers the cycle. Predict what would happen to evaporation on a cold, cloudy day compared to a hot, sunny day. Explain why.

Confidence check. Circle one after you finish: I still need the cue / I need it once in a while / I can explain this without it.

Teacher Key — The Water Cycle

Remove this page before student copying. Answers below give expected ideas, not required wording.

Retrieve It

1. The Sun (the Sun's energy).
2. Evaporation.
3. Clouds (made of tiny water drops).
4. Any: rain, snow, sleet, or hail.

Sketch It — look for

Sun shown, arrows going up from a lake (evaporation), a cloud forming (condensation), and rain falling (precipitation), with the three labels placed correctly.

Apply It

1. Evaporation; the liquid water turned into water vapor and rose into the air.
2. Condensation; water vapor in the air cooled near the cold glass and turned back into liquid drops.
3. Collection or runoff; the water may flow to a lake, river, or ocean, then evaporate again.

Reason from Evidence — look for

Not correct. No new water is made. The same water is recycled again and again as it evaporates, condenses, and falls as precipitation.

ACE — Extend look-for

Less evaporation on a cold, cloudy day; more evaporation on a hot, sunny day because the Sun's heat gives water the energy to become vapor.

Suggested use. Run Page 1 with the cue card available, Page 2 with the cue mostly covered, and Page 3 as independent reflection. Let students uncover the cue to self-correct in a different color.